

Stack & Save - Complete Setup Guide

This guide takes you from zero to a fully automated posting machine.

Do the stages ****in order****. Do not skip ahead.

Every field you will see on any screen is written out here. Nothing is left to guess.

Total time: about 2 hours, once. Cost: zero.

When you finish: pages post twice a day by themselves, with your laptop off.

Your three identities, used everywhere in this guide:

Thing	Value
Brand name	Stack & Save
Handle (IG and FB)	stackandsavehq
Niche	SaaS tools / free trials

Keep this PDF open while you work. Tick stages off as you finish them.

STAGE 1 - Instagram account (15 minutes)

You will create a professional Instagram account for the brand.

1.1. Open [instagram.com](https://www.instagram.com) in your browser and log in to your personal Instagram (or create one if you have none - you will not use this account publicly).

1.2. Click your profile picture (top right) and choose "Switch to professional account". If you do not see it, go to Settings and look for "Account type and tools".

1.3. Instagram shows a setup wizard. Enter these values:

Screen question	What to pick / type
What best describes you?	Creator (or Business - either works; pick Creator)
Select a category	Digital creator (alternatives if Digital creator is missing: "Content creator", "Entrepreneur")
Do you want to display it?	Your choice; both fine. Recommend Yes for credibility
Are you a musician?	No
Contact options	Skip (press Next / Skip)
Share logins using Accounts Center	Skip
Connect to Facebook now?	SKIP for now - Stage 2 does it properly

1.4. Set your profile fields. Go to "Edit profile" and fill exactly:

Field	Value to paste
Name (NOT username)	Stack & Save \ SaaS Tools (max 30 chars - longer gets rejected)
Username	stackandsavehq
If taken, try in order	stackandsave, stackandsave_, get.stackandsave
Website	(leave empty now - you will paste in Stage 6.4)
Bio	The stack that saves you hours. Free trials only. [press Enter once here] New SaaS tools weekly. Honest takes. Start free (below)
Category (public)	Digital creator
Profile photo	Upload file: public/brand/avatar.png (from your project folder)

1.5. Confirm the account is a professional account:

Settings -> Account type and tools -> it should say "Switch to personal account" (meaning you already are professional).

Stage 1 done when: your profile shows "Digital creator" under the name, avatar uploaded, bio pasted.

STAGE 2 - Facebook Page (10 minutes)

You already use Meta Business Suite - create the Page INSIDE it (recommended):

2.1. Browser -> business.facebook.com -> log in with your normal Facebook login.

2.2. Left menu "All tools" -> Settings (gear icon) -> left "Accounts" -> "Pages" -> button "Add" -> "Create a new Page". Fill: Name "Stack & Save", Category: type "software" and pick "Software". Create. The Page now lives in your Business Portfolio, fully separate from your existing niche Page.

(Alternative, equally fine: facebook.com/pages/create while logged in, then claim it afterwards: Business Suite -> Settings -> Accounts -> Pages -> Add -> "Add an existing Page". Use EITHER path, never both.)

2.3. Fill the Page's fields exactly (during creation or right after in Edit details):

Field	Value to paste
Page name	Stack & Save
Category - type and pick	Type "software" and pick "Software" from the suggestions (the category box is a search, not a dropdown). Equally fine: "Software Company", "Information Technology Company", "Internet Company", or "Science, Technology & Engineering". Any tech category works - it does not affect posting or reach.
Second category (optional)	Skip - you can add one later in Edit details
Bio (255 chars max)	SaaS tools that save you hours. Free trials, honest breakdowns, zero hype. Start every tool free.

2.4. Click "Create Page".

2.5. The Page setup checklist appears on the left. Fill these:

Checklist item	Value
Profile picture	Upload public/brand/avatar.png
Cover photo	Skip (optional; social_card.png can be cropped later)
Action button	Skip
Add website	Skip now (Stage 6.4)

2.6. While on the new Page, note the Page's web address (it will be like facebook.com/stackandsave-123456). Fine for now.

2.7. ALSO claim the handle: Page -> Settings (gear) -> Page setup / Username -> Set username -> try "stackandsavehq" first; if taken, same fallbacks as Stage 1.4.

If Page settings items look greyed out: that is normal for a brand-new Page (insights, monetization, ads unlock as the Page gets activity - the crossed icons mean "not available YET", not broken). If Username will not open, try:

(a) business.facebook.com -> Settings gear -> Accounts -> Pages -> your Page -> open it and look for "Page setup"; or (b) the Meta Business Suite mobile

app -> your Page -> settings; or (c) wait 24-48h - Meta gates brand-new Pages, then unlocks username. The Page works fully without a username.

Stage 2 done when: the Page exists, avatar uploaded, username claimed.

STAGE 3 - Link Instagram to the Facebook Page (3 minutes)

This link is what makes automated posting possible at all.

3.1. Open the Instagram app on your phone (easier than browser for this).

3.2. Go to your professional account -> Edit profile -> under "Page" or "Public business details" tap "Connect or create".

3.3. Choose your existing Facebook Page: Stack & Save. Approve.

3.4. Back in browser as a cross-check: facebook.com -> your Page -> Settings -> Linked accounts -> Instagram: it should show your @stackandsavehq handle.

Stage 3 done when: the Page settings show the Instagram account linked.

IMPORTANT: link ONLY here (in the Instagram app). This creates the real connection; Business Suite merely displays it. Afterwards just VERIFY in business.facebook.com -> Settings -> Accounts -> Instagram accounts - your handle should be listed. Only if it does not appear there after a few minutes, add it manually there; it will not duplicate.

> **Already have a Meta Business Suite / Business Portfolio?** Perfect -
> everything below lives INSIDE it. Do NOT touch your existing FB+IG pair.
> The new Page and IG account join your same Business Portfolio; you'll just
> see them listed alongside. Isolation rules that keep the niches apart:
> (1) create the new Instagram with a DIFFERENT email than your other IG
> (unique email aliases, e.g. Brave aliases, count - one alias per account);
> (2) when the IG app offers "sync contacts" / "find friends" - SKIP both;
> (3) never cross-follow or cross-like between your two niches' accounts;
> (4) in Stage 5's token wizard, tick ONLY the new Page + new IG in the
> asset list, so the app's permissions never touch your old accounts.
> pick "Stack & Save" instead of your existing assets in every dropdown.
> In the Graph API Explorer (Stage 5), after generating the token you'll see
> an asset list - tick ONLY the new Page. Your existing accounts stay invisible
> to the automation.

STAGE 4 - Meta developer app + permissions (20 minutes)

This creates the "key" the automation uses. Free, official, safe.

4.1. Go to developers.facebook.com and log in with your Facebook account.

4.2. Click "Get Started" (or My Apps -> Create App).

4.3. Fill the app creation form exactly:

Field	Value to paste
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App name

	Stack & Save Engine
App contact email	your real email
App purpose	Manage business integration (or "Business" if asked as type)
If asked "What do you want to build?"	Business

4.4. Inside the app dashboard, left menu -> "Use cases" or "Products" -> find "Instagram Graph API" and add it. Also add "Facebook Login for Business" if shown.

4.5. Left menu -> Settings -> Basic. Fill:

Field	Value
App domains	meta-fb-redirects.com (Meta no longer accepts "localhost"; any placeholder domain works - the engine never uses it)
Contact email	your email
Privacy Policy URL	skip for now (not needed while app is in Development mode)
Category	Business and pages
Icon	skip
Save changes (button bottom)	click it

4.6. Note two values shown on that Basic page: App ID and App secret. You WILL need both in Stage 5 - the wizard uses them to make your posting token never expire.

4.7. Add yourself as a tester/owner (usually automatic - you are the admin because you created the app).

4.8. Leave the app in Development mode (toggle at top of dashboard says "Development"). This is enough for posting to your own accounts. If a screen ever says the app must be live, only then continue to 4.9.

4.9. (Only if required) App Review: click "Start verification", provide the screencast it asks for showing your posting dashboard; the permissions used by this engine (instagram_content_publish, instagram_basic, pages_read_engagement, pages_show_list, pages_manage_posts, instagram_manage_comments, business_management) are standard for "manage my own business" cases.

Stage 4 done when: the app exists, Development mode shows on the dashboard.

STAGE 5 - The token (10 minutes, needs Stages 1-4 done)

5.1. In your project folder open a terminal and run:

```
python scripts/setup_tokens.py
(Have your App ID and App secret from 4.6 handy - the wizard asks for them so your posting token becomes never-expiring.)
```

5.2. The wizard asks for a "short-lived token". Get it:

5.3. Open a new browser tab to developers.facebook.com/tools/explorer

5.4. On that page:

Control	What to do
"Meta App" dropdown (top right)	Pick "Stack & Save Engine"

"User or Page" dropdown

	Leave as "User" for now
Permissions dropdown (right side)	Click and add ALL of: pages_show_list, pages_read_engagement, instagram_basic, instagram_content_publish, pages_manage_posts, instagram_manage_comments, business_management
"Generate Access Token" button	Click it, approve the permission popups (Continue -> OK)

5.5. The big text box now contains a long string starting with "EAAG" or similar. Click the copy icon, go back to the terminal running `setup_tokens.py`, paste it, press Enter.

5.6. The wizard lists your Facebook Pages. Type 0 (or the number next to "Stack & Save") and press Enter.

5.7. The wizard:

- converts to a never-expiring Page token,
- writes `IG_USER_ID`, `FB_PAGE_ID`, `ACCESS_TOKEN` into the `.env` file,
- prints "@stackandsavehq connected".

5.8. Copy `.env.example` to `.env` first if not done (the wizard also creates it).

Stage 5 done when: terminal prints the connected @stackandsavehq message.

Run `python scripts/doctor.py` - the credentials lines now show [ok].

STAGE 6 - GitHub: free hosting + 24/7 scheduler (15 minutes)

6.1. Go to github.com and create a free account (or log in).

6.2. Click the + icon (top right) -> "New repository".

Owner dropdown: pick your PERSONAL account (or a dedicated org), not an org hosting your existing site/repos - keeps this experiment isolated.

Field	Value
Owner	your personal account (or a new org)
Repository name	affiliate-engine
Description (optional)	Automated SaaS affiliate posting
Visibility	Private (recommended)
Add README	Do NOT tick
Click "Create repository"	

6.2b. GitHub Pages on a PRIVATE repo requires GitHub Pro/Team. On Free:

- Option A (zero cost): make THIS repo public - your site is just tool links and renders; nothing sensitive. Secrets stay private regardless.
- Option B: your existing hosted website - put a folder `/stack` on it and serve docs/ contents there instead (set `PUBLIC_MEDIA_BASE_URL` to it).
- Option C: GitHub Pro (~\$4/mo) if you insist on private + Pages.

6.3. Connect your local project to it. In your project terminal run (replace YOURUSER):

```
git init
git add .
git commit -m "affiliate engine initial"
git branch -M main
```

```
git remote add origin https://github.com/YOURUSER/affiliate-engine.git
git push -u origin main
```

(If git is missing: install from git-scm.com, accept defaults, reopen terminal.)

6.4. Turn on Pages (this is your free link-in-bio hosting):

Repo -> Settings -> left "Pages" -> "Deploy from a branch" ->

Branch: main, Folder: /docs -> Save.

The site URL appears in ~2 minutes, like https://YOURUSER.github.io/affiliate-engine/

6.5. Paste that URL as your bio Website field:

- Instagram: Edit profile -> Website -> paste -> Done
- Facebook Page: Page -> Edit details -> Website -> paste

6.6. Add the scheduler secrets: Repo -> Settings -> "Secrets and variables" ->

"Actions" -> button "New repository secret" - add each of these five, one at a time, values copied from your .env file:

Secret Name field	Value field
IG_USER_ID	(value of IG_USER_ID from .env)
FB_PAGE_ID	(value of FB_PAGE_ID from .env)
ACCESS_TOKEN	(value of ACCESS_TOKEN from .env)
GEMINI_API_KEY	(AI copywriter - copy the value from your .env)
PEXELS_API_KEY	(stock photos - copy the value from your .env)

6.7. About the .env file: it holds your secrets. It is already listed in

.gitignore, so git will never upload it - that is correct and safe. You never commit it, and you never add it to GitHub. The scheduler workflow gets its Pages URL automatically. Nothing to do in this step.

6.8. Test the scheduler once by hand: Repo -> Actions tab -> left "scheduler" ->

"Run workflow" dropdown -> green "Run workflow" button -> wait ~5 minutes.

Watch the steps go green. Then check instagram.com/@stackandsavehq - first post should be live.

Stage 6 done when: the manual workflow run posts to your IG + FB.

STAGE 7 - First-week routine (5 minutes/day, then hands-off)

Day 1 after go-live:

- Confirm the scheduled runs: Repo -> Actions -> list shows runs at ~18:00 (IST) and ~05:00 (IST, next morning) - those are 08:30 and 19:30 US-Eastern, the prime windows for the US audience this engine targets.
- Post 1 Story manually on IG: screenshot your first post + "New tools weekly" text. Stories cannot be automated without extra app review; this is the one daily human touch that boosts reach.

Every Sunday (5 minutes):

- Run python scripts/insights.py
- Replace the 3 weakest hashtags in data/hashtags.txt
- Add 1-2 new tools to data/products.csv (with your referral link)
- Commit + push: git add . && git commit -m "weekly refresh" && git push

If anything breaks:

- Run python scripts/doctor.py - it names the broken part.

Troubleshooting quick answers

Symptom	Fix
"Insufficient Developer Role" in explorer	Log into the right FB account; you must be admin of both app and Page
Token wizard finds no Pages	Stage 3 link missing, or pages_show_list permission missing - redo 4.4/5.4
Publish error "media download failed"	Pages not live yet; wait 2 min after workflow or check Settings->Pages
Publish error 9007 / PERMISSION	Page Publishing Authorization required: Page settings -> New Pages Experience -> complete the 2-step check
Reels publish but no sound	No music file in assets/music/ - drop any royalty-free .mp3 there
Workflow red at "Publish" step	Run doctor.py --live; token likely invalidated by password change - rerun setup_tokens.py

What is automated vs what is you

AUTOMATED (never your job): copywriting, hashtags, captions, slide design, reel rendering, scheduling, publishing to IG + FB, link-bio page, hosting, media hosting, insights gathering, posting logs.

YOU (once): Stages 1-6 above. YOU (5 min/week): Stage 7 Sunday ritual.

YOU (optional, big boost): drop tool screenshots into data/product_images/ and screen recordings into data/screen_recordings/ - named <id>.jpg / <id>.mp4 using the id column from products.csv.